Level 2, middle-aged clients, elephant

Level 2, middle-aged clients, 50 min. Peak: Elephant

Warm up — 15 min

1. Footwork — 6 min, Reformer



Footwork: heel lowers and lifts — 1½ min, x10
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Legs long, balls of feet on FB; Lower heels under, lift high; Keep knees soft, not locked



Footwork: calf stretch under the bar — 1 min, 3 slow holds
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Legs long, heels under FB; Hold 3 breaths, lift, repeat; Soft knees if tight



Footwork with chest press — 2 min, x10
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Toes par, wts in hands; Press legs out, arms up; Ribs soft, HNS optional



Footwork: toes, Pilates V — 1½ min, x10
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Heels together, toes apart (V); Turn out from the hips; Squeeze inner thighs out

2. Bridge — 4 min, Reformer



Bridge with carriage press — 2 min, x8
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Lift to bridge, hold hips up; Press carr out and in; Hips stay high and level



Single leg bridge, leg to ceiling — 2 min, x6 ea
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
One foot on FB, other leg up; Lift and lower hips; Pelvis square

3. Abs and supine arms — 5 min, Reformer



Chest press with light weights — 1 min, x10
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Lie on carr, feet on FB; Wts at chest, press up; Lower slow, elbows wide



Kneeling hover on the carriage — 1 min, 3 holds of 10 sec
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Hands on FB, knees on carr; Feet on SR, hover knees; Back flat, carr still



Hundred with legs in tabletop — 1 min, 100 beats
Springs: Light, 1 red
Arms in straps, legs TT; HNS, pump arms; Inh 5, Exh 5



Coordination — 2 min, x6
Springs: Light, 1 red
Legs TT, arms in straps, HNS; Press arms + legs out; Open close legs, bend in

Strength and tone — 18 min

4. Plank — 3 min, Reformer



Side support on the reformer — 1½ min, x5 ea
Springs: Light, 1 red
One hand on FB, side to bar; Feet stacked on carr edge; Press carr out, lift hips



Reformer plank — 1½ min, 3 holds of 20 sec
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Hands on FB, feet on plat side; Long line, carr still; Breathe, hold, rest

5. Lower body — 4 min, Reformer



Side splits — 2 min, x8
Springs: Light, 1 red
One foot on plat, one on carr; Press carr out, legs wide; Squeeze to close, tall spine



Scooter — 2 min, x10 ea
Springs: Light, 1 red
Hands on FB, one knee on carr; Standing leg soft on floor; Push carr back w/ bent leg

6. Upper back — 4 min, Reformer



Seated biceps, arms wide — 1 min, x10
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Sit facing straps, arms wide; Curl hands to shoulders; Elbows still, slow back



Kneeling biceps — 1 min, x10
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Kneel tall facing straps; Arms at shoulder height; Curl to temples, elbows high



Kneeling side arm — 2 min, x8 ea
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Kneel sideways, one strap; Pull arm down to side; Hips stacked, long waist

Second half

From minute 26. 0 equipment changes, 8 spring changes

Strength and tone, continued — 18 min

7. Upper front — 4 min, Reformer



Incline push-ups on the footbar — 1 min, x8
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Stand, hands on FB, step back; Long line head to heels; Bend elbows, press away



Seated triceps with light weights — 1½ min, x10
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Sit tall on carr, one wt in both hands; Lower behind head; Press up, elbows in



Magic circle chest press — 1½ min, x10
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Sit tall, MC at chest; Squeeze ring, Exh; Release halfway, keep lift

8. Side body and rotation — 3 min, Reformer



Seated side reach with magic circle — 1 min, x5 ea
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Sit tall, MC overhead; Reach up and over to one side; Both sit bns stay down



Mermaid with twist — 2 min, x3 ea
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Side sit, push carr out; Turn chest to FB, hands on bar; Lengthen, unwind, return

Functional — 12 min

9. Full body — 7 min, Reformer



Teaser on the reformer — 1½ min, x4
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Hold straps, legs long at angle; Roll up to V balance; Roll down bone by bone

Seated rotation with one strap — 1½ min, x6 ea
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Side sit, both hands on 1 strap; Rotate away, arms at chest; Return slow, hips still



Seated roll back with straps — 2 min, x6
Springs: Very light, 1 blue
Sit tall facing straps, hold straps; Exh, roll back to C-curve; Inh hold, Exh roll up tall



Elephant PEAK — 2 min, x8
Springs: Light, 1 red
Hands on FB, heels on carr; Hips high, inverted V; Push carr back with legs

10. Back extension — 5 min, Reformer



Seated chest lift at the footbar — 1 min, x6
Springs: Light, 1 red
Sit facing FB, hands on FB; Lift chest forward and up; Long neck, return tall



Swan prep on the carriage — 1 min, x6
Springs: Light, 1 red
Lie face down, hands on FB; Press bar, lift chest a little; Lower slow, long neck



Quadruped hold on the carriage — 1½ min, 5 slow breaths x3
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Knees on carr, hands on FB; Long flat back; Tiny press back, hold, return



Bird dog on the carriage — 1½ min, x5 ea
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Hands on FB, knees on carr; Reach one leg back long; Hips level, switch

Lengthening — 5 min

11. Stretch — 5 min, Reformer



Seated breathing, arms circle — 1 min, x5
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Sit tall on carr; Inh, arms float up; Exh, arms float down



Seated spine stretch on the carriage — 1 min, x4
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Sit tall facing FB, legs wide; Hands on FB, round forward; Stack up tall



Figure 4 stretch, foot on footbar — 1½ min, 3 breaths ea
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
One foot on FB; Cross ankle over knee; Bend in a little, switch



Hip rolls on the carriage — 1½ min, x4 ea
Springs: Heavy, 3 red
Heels on FB, knees together; Knees drop to one side; Exh to center, switch

Key. TT Tabletop, legs at 90 degrees; **HNS** Head and shoulders lifted; **FB** Footbar; **SR** Shoulder rests; **carr** Carriage; **plat** Platform; **par** Parallel legs; **V** Pilates V, heels together, toes apart; **ea** Each side; **x** Repetitions, so x8 means 8 times; **Inh** Inhale; **Exh** Exhale; **sit bns** Sit bones; **w/** With; **sec** Seconds; **wts** Light weights; **MC** Magic circle. Springs: red heavy, blue medium, yellow light. Older clients start lighter. Springs as listed.